

Medical Records & Death Certificates

How to obtain certified death certificates and request your loved one's medical records.

Death certificates

Certified copies of the death certificate are usually provided through your **funeral home**. Many families need **ten or more** certified copies, banks, insurers, and government agencies often each require an original. Ask your funeral director to order the number you expect to need.

Requesting medical records for someone who has died

Under Michigan law, the records of a person who has died may be released only to the **executor (personal representative) of the estate**. A request must include a signed authorization **and** a letter of authority issued by the Probate Court (MCL 600.2157).

Send the completed authorization to:

EMAIL

HFHSMedicalRecords@HFHS.org

Health Information Management

FAX

313-916-3917

MAIL

HFH Information Dept.

1414 E Maple Road, Troy, MI 48083

Your authorization must include:

- 1 The patient's full name, date of birth, address, and phone (and any previous names)
- 2 Who the information should be sent to (name and address)
- 3 The specific information requested (provider, type of report, and dates of service)
- 4 The signature of the executor, with a copy of the letter of authority / guardianship or power of attorney
- 5 The date of the signature

Why a letter of authority is required

Releasing a deceased patient's records to anyone other than the estate's executor is not permitted under Michigan law (MCL 600.2157). The Probate Court issues the letter of authority to the executor; your attorney or the court can help you obtain it.